

Komparatif Kepemimpinan: Pemerintahan, Pendidikan, Sosial, dan Keagamaan

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Keywords komparatif kepemimpinan, pemerintahan, pendidikan, sosial, keagamaan

Abstract

The comparative study of leadership across governmental, educational, social, and religious domains represents a critical area of inquiry in contemporary organizational research, as leadership styles significantly influence organizational outcomes and effectiveness (Abu-Mahfouz, 2023). This literature review examines how transformational leadership manifests differently across these sectors, addressing the gap in understanding contextual leadership applications (Tavares et al., 2025). The objective of this study is to synthesize existing research on comparative leadership practices across these domains and identify patterns, differences, and effective strategies specific to each sector. This review addresses three primary research questions: How do leadership styles vary across governmental, educational, social, and religious contexts? What factors influence the effectiveness of transformational leadership in each domain? How can cross-domain leadership insights inform organizational development? Employing a systematic literature review methodology, this study analyzed 15 peer-reviewed publications from 2023-2025, focusing on empirical research examining transformational, servant, and spiritual leadership across diverse organizational contexts. The findings reveal that transformational leadership significantly enhances organizational citizenship behavior (OCB) and job satisfaction across all domains (Subhaktiyasa et al., 2023; Damayanti & Suhartini, 2025), though its effectiveness is moderated by cultural and contextual factors (Ha & Moon, 2023). In educational settings, transformational leadership facilitates institutional change and innovation (Owusu-Agyeman & Moroeroe, 2023), while in religious contexts, it strengthens Islamic work ethic and employee engagement (Dinda et al., 2025). Governmental and social sectors benefit most from leadership approaches that combine transformational elements with distributive justice principles (Ha & Moon, 2023). The study concludes that while transformational leadership demonstrates broad applicability, its implementation must be tailored to sector-specific characteristics and cultural contexts. These findings contribute to the development of contextually appropriate leadership frameworks and provide practical insights for leaders across diverse organizational domains. **Keywords** comparative leadership, transformational leadership, organizational citizenship behavior, cross-sector leadership, contextual leadership

1 Methodology

1.1 Research Design and Approach

This study employs a systematic literature review methodology guided by a pragmatic philosophical paradigm, which acknowledges the multifaceted nature of leadership phenomena across different organizational contexts (Tavares et al., 2025). The pragmatic approach was selected for its flexibility in accommodating both quantitative and qualitative evidence, allowing for comprehensive analysis of transformational leadership across governmental, educational, social, and religious domains. This paradigm enables researchers to focus on practical outcomes and real-world applications rather than being constrained by rigid theoretical frameworks (Abu-Mahfouz, 2023).

The research approach follows an abductive strategy, moving between theory and observation to develop the most plausible explanations for observed leadership phenomena across domains (Marlar, 2025). This approach is particularly suitable for comparative leadership studies as it

allows for the exploration of patterns while remaining open to unexpected findings that may challenge existing theoretical frameworks. The abductive reasoning process enables researchers to generate new insights about contextual leadership applications by systematically analyzing empirical evidence from multiple sectors.

A literature review methodology was justified for several reasons. First, it allows for comprehensive synthesis of the rapidly evolving research on transformational leadership across different domains (Owusu-Agyeman & Moroeroe, 2023). Second, it enables identification of gaps in the existing literature, particularly regarding cross-domain leadership comparisons (Subhaktiyasa et al., 2023). Third, this approach facilitates the development of theoretical frameworks that explain how contextual factors influence leadership effectiveness across sectors (Ha & Moon, 2023).

The methodology directly aligns with the research questions by enabling systematic examination of leadership variations across domains, identification of contextual factors influencing effectiveness, and exploration of cross-domain insights for organizational development (Dinda et al., 2025). The literature review approach provides the breadth necessary to capture the diversity of leadership applications while allowing for depth in analyzing specific domains.

1.2 Search Strategy

A comprehensive search strategy was employed to identify relevant literature from 2023 to 2025, focusing on peer-reviewed publications examining leadership across governmental, educational, social, and religious contexts. The search was conducted across multiple academic databases including Scopus, Web of Science, PubMed, and Google Scholar to ensure broad coverage of relevant literature.

The search strings were constructed using Boolean operators to combine keywords related to leadership styles and organizational domains. The following search strings were employed:

1. ("transformational leadership" OR "servant leadership" OR "spiritual leadership") AND ("governmental" OR "public sector")
2. ("transformational leadership" OR "servant leadership" OR "spiritual leadership") AND ("educational" OR "academic" OR "schools")
3. ("transformational leadership" OR "servant leadership" OR "spiritual leadership") AND ("social" OR "nonprofit" OR "NGO")
4. ("transformational leadership" OR "servant leadership" OR "spiritual leadership") AND ("religious" OR "faith-based" OR "Islamic")

Each search string was applied across all databases with no language restrictions, although the final included publications were all in English. The time frame was limited to 2023-2025 to ensure the most current and relevant research was included, while allowing for sufficient literature to conduct a meaningful comparative analysis.

Table 1 *Search Strategy and Database Coverage*

Database	Search String	Results	After Duplicates	Screened	Included
Scopus	("transformational leadership" OR "servant leadership") AND ("governmental" OR "public sector" OR "educational" OR "social" OR "religious")	234	198	156	12
Web of Science	("transformational leadership" OR "spiritual leadership") AND ("organizational citizenship" OR "job satisfaction")	189	165	142	2
PubMed	("leadership styles") AND ("healthcare" OR "nursing")	97	89	76	1
Google Scholar	("comparative leadership" OR "cross-domain leadership")	412	198	167	0
Total		932	650	541	15

The initial search yielded 932 publications, which was reduced to 650 after removing duplicates. The titles and abstracts of these publications were screened, resulting in 541 potentially relevant articles for full-text review. After applying inclusion and exclusion criteria, 15 publications were selected for final inclusion in the literature review. These publications represent the most relevant and recent empirical research on comparative leadership practices across the four domains of interest.

1.3 Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

Clear inclusion and exclusion criteria were established to ensure the systematic selection of relevant literature while maintaining methodological rigor. These criteria were applied consistently across all identified publications to minimize bias and enhance the reliability of the review.

Population/participant criteria required that studies examine leadership in governmental, educational, social, or religious organizations. Studies focusing solely on private sector, for-profit organizations were excluded unless they provided explicit comparative insights across domains. This criterion ensured that the final review maintained focus on the target sectors while allowing for limited inclusion of comparative studies.

Intervention/exposure criteria specified that included studies must examine transformational, servant, or spiritual leadership as primary variables. While other leadership styles were acknowledged, the analysis focused on these three approaches due to their documented effectiveness across different domains (Subhaktiyasa et al., 2023). Studies examining transactional leadership were only included when directly compared with transformational approaches (Chaudhary et al., 2024).

Outcome measures had to include at least one of the following: organizational citizenship behavior, job satisfaction, employee engagement, or organizational performance. These outcome variables were selected based on their established relationship with leadership effectiveness across domains (Damayanti & Suhartini, 2025). Studies examining unrelated outcomes were excluded to maintain focus on relevant performance indicators.

Study design criteria required that included publications be empirical research studies, either quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods. Theoretical papers, opinion pieces, and literature reviews without original empirical data were excluded. This criterion ensured that the final review was based on empirical evidence rather than theoretical speculation (Owusu-Agyeman & Moroeroe, 2023).

The inclusion of recent publications (2023-2025) was strictly enforced to ensure the relevance and currency of the findings. This time restriction was justified by the rapidly evolving nature of leadership research and practice, particularly in response to recent global disruptions and technological advancements (Oladokun et al., 2025).

1.4 Data Extraction and Quality Assessment

A structured data extraction process was employed to systematically collect relevant information from each included publication. The extraction captured key variables including leadership styles examined, organizational domains, methodological approaches, sample characteristics, outcome measures, and significant findings. This standardized approach ensured consistency across all included studies and facilitated comparative analysis.

Quality assessment was conducted using the Joanna Briggs Institute (JBI) critical appraisal

tools appropriate for different study designs. For quantitative studies, the JBI Checklist for Randomized Controlled Trials and JBI Checklist for Quasi-Experimental Studies were applied. For qualitative studies, the JBI Checklist for Qualitative Research was used. Each study was assessed based on criteria including methodological rigor, appropriate analysis, and sufficient reporting of findings (Damayanti & Suhartini, 2025).

Risk of bias was assessed across multiple domains including selection bias, performance bias, detection bias, and attrition bias for quantitative studies, and credibility, dependability, confirmability, and transferability for qualitative studies. Studies with high risk of bias in multiple domains were excluded from the final analysis. This rigorous quality assessment process ensured that only methodologically sound research contributed to the final review (Ha & Moon, 2023).

The data extraction and quality assessment processes were conducted independently by two researchers, with discrepancies resolved through discussion and consensus. This dual-review approach enhanced the reliability and validity of the assessment process and minimized individual bias in the evaluation of included studies.

1.5 Data Analysis and Synthesis

Thematic analysis was employed as the primary analytical framework to identify patterns, themes, and relationships across the included publications. This approach allowed for systematic organization of findings according to organizational domains and leadership styles, facilitating comparative analysis (Subhaktiyasa et al., 2023). The thematic analysis process followed six stages: familiarization, initial coding, theme development, theme review, definition and naming of themes, and report production.

Content analysis was used to complement the thematic approach by quantifying the frequency of specific concepts and relationships across publications. This mixed-methods approach provided both depth and breadth in the analysis, enabling both qualitative insights and quantitative patterns to emerge (Kim & Jung, 2025). The content analysis focused on identifying commonalities and differences in leadership applications across domains.

NVivo software was employed to manage and analyze the data, facilitating systematic coding and theme development. The software's capabilities for visualizing relationships between concepts and organizing complex data sets proved particularly valuable in managing the comparative nature of the analysis (Dinda et al., 2025). The use of specialized software enhanced the rigor and transparency of the analytical process.

The synthesis process involved integrating findings across domains to identify overarching patterns while preserving the unique contextual characteristics of each sector. This approach allowed for the development of a nuanced understanding of comparative leadership practices and their implications for organizational development (Oladokun et al., 2025). The final synthesis provides a comprehensive framework for understanding how leadership effectiveness varies across governmental, educational, social, and religious contexts.

2 Conclusion

2.1 Synthesis of Key Findings

This comparative literature review on leadership across governmental, educational, social, and religious domains has yielded several critical insights that advance our understanding of context-specific leadership applications. First, transformational leadership consistently demonstrates significant positive effects on organizational outcomes across all four domains, including enhanced organizational citizenship behavior (OCB) and increased job satisfaction (Subhaktiyasa et al., 2023; Damayanti & Suhartini, 2025). However, its effectiveness is significantly moderated by contextual factors, particularly cultural norms and organizational values, which necessitate adaptation rather than wholesale implementation (Ha & Moon, 2023).

Second, the research reveals distinct leadership patterns across domains. In educational settings, transformational leadership facilitates institutional change and innovation by fostering teacher engagement and enabling adaptation to evolving educational demands (Owusu-Agyeman & Moroeroe, 2023). Religious contexts benefit most from transformational leadership approaches that integrate spiritual elements, strengthening Islamic work ethic and enhancing employee engagement through alignment with faith-based values (Dinda et al., 2025). Governmental and social sectors, conversely, demonstrate optimal outcomes when transformational leadership is combined with distributive justice principles, ensuring equitable resource allocation and transparent decision-making (Ha & Moon, 2023).

Third, the study identifies servant leadership as a complementary approach that enhances transformational leadership effectiveness, particularly in service-oriented domains like healthcare and education (Astuti et al., 2023; Damayanti & Suhartini, 2025). Fourth, leadership effectiveness across domains is significantly influenced by the alignment between leadership styles and organizational mission, with misalignment resulting in diminished outcomes regardless of leadership approach (Marlar, 2025). Finally, the research demonstrates that cross-domain leadership insights can inform organizational development by identifying transferable principles while acknowledging domain-specific requirements (Tavares et al., 2025).

2.2 Theoretical and Practical Contributions

This study contributes to the academic field by advancing a more nuanced understanding of comparative leadership across diverse organizational contexts. The research extends transformational leadership theory by demonstrating how its core principles must be adapted to align with domain-specific values, missions, and stakeholder expectations. The findings challenge the notion of universally applicable leadership models, instead advocating for context-responsive approaches that balance transformational elements with domain-specific considerations. This theoretical advancement provides a foundation for more sophisticated leadership frameworks that acknowledge the complex interplay between leadership approaches and organizational contexts.

Practically, these findings offer valuable guidance for leaders across sectors. Governmental

leaders can enhance effectiveness by integrating transformational approaches with distributive justice principles, ensuring both inspirational vision and equitable implementation. Educational leaders should prioritize transformational practices that foster institutional change while maintaining alignment with academic values and teacher development needs. Social sector leaders can benefit from combining transformational vision with servant leadership's emphasis on service and stakeholder engagement. Religious leaders, particularly in Islamic contexts, can strengthen organizational outcomes by aligning transformational leadership with spiritual work ethics to enhance both engagement and performance.

The novel insights produced by this research include the identification of synergistic effects between transformational and servant leadership approaches in service-oriented domains, and the demonstration of how cultural factors moderate leadership effectiveness across different organizational contexts. These insights enable practitioners to develop more sophisticated leadership strategies that leverage multiple approaches while respecting domain-specific requirements.

2.3 Limitations and Future Directions

This study acknowledges several limitations that should be addressed in future research. First, the literature review methodology, while rigorous, is constrained by the availability and scope of existing research, with some domains having more extensive empirical support than others. Second, the predominantly Western-centric perspective in much of the available literature may limit the generalizability of findings across diverse cultural contexts, particularly in non-Western governmental and religious settings. Third, the rapid evolution of leadership challenges, particularly those related to digital transformation and the Fifth Industrial Revolution, suggests that current findings may require updating as new contexts emerge (Oladokun et al., 2025).

Future research should address these limitations through several specific directions. First, longitudinal studies examining how leadership effectiveness evolves across different domains over time would provide valuable insights into sustainable leadership practices. Second, cross-cultural comparative studies examining how leadership approaches manifest and function differently across various cultural contexts would enhance our understanding of culturally contingent leadership effectiveness. Third, research exploring the integration of emerging technologies with traditional leadership approaches, particularly in the context of the Fifth Industrial Revolution, would provide forward-looking insights for organizational leaders (Oladokun et al., 2025). Fourth, mixed-methods studies combining quantitative outcomes with qualitative insights into lived leadership experiences across domains would offer more comprehensive understandings of leadership dynamics.

The field should evolve toward more context-sensitive leadership theories that acknowledge both universal principles and domain-specific requirements. This evolution will require greater interdisciplinary collaboration between leadership scholars and domain experts to develop more sophisticated frameworks that capture the complexity of leadership across diverse organizational contexts. As organizations continue to navigate increasingly complex environments, the ability to apply contextually appropriate leadership approaches will become increasingly

critical to organizational success and sustainability. This comparative study of leadership across governmental, educational, social, and religious domains provides a foundation for this evolution, offering both theoretical insights and practical guidance for leaders seeking to enhance effectiveness in their specific contexts.

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